HWABELLE BOTANICALS

Pressing Calla Lilies and Baby’s Breath

A calm, modern guide to preparing fresh calla lilies and airy baby’s breath for the Hwabelle press.



Fresh flowers, carefully arranged, beautifully remembered.

CALLA LILY EDITION

A gentle four-part rhythm

Calla lilies bring bold color and a graceful trumpet shape. Baby’s breath adds a fine, airy counterpoint. The key is to prepare both flowers so the press can hold them flat without crowding.

01

CHOOSE

Select fresh, dry flowers with clean color.

02

PREPARE

Separate the bloom from bulky stems and arrange it flat.

03

PRESS

Build the layers, seat the top plate, and tighten evenly.

04

REVEAL

Open gently and lift the dried flowers from the paper.

THE FLOWER PAIRING

Orange calla lily | Golden-yellow calla lily | White baby’s breath | Cream paper | Clear acrylic | Brass hardware

01 CHOOSE

Select the flowers



HOW TO

Choose calla lilies with clean, open spathes and firm color. Gather baby’s breath that is dry to the touch and free of condensation. Keep the stems separate while you inspect each flower.

CRAFT NOTE

Work with flowers that are fresh but not wet. Moisture trapped in the stack can mark paper and slow drying.

Keep every stem distinct



HOW TO

Set the bouquet down and separate the flowers before arranging them. Each calla lily should have one flower on one clear stem. Remove tangled pieces and keep baby’s breath in light, individual sprigs.

CRAFT NOTE

The stem structure should be easy to understand at a glance. If a flower appears to branch into multiple stems, separate it before pressing.

Trim bulky stems



HOW TO

Trim only the bulky stem material that would keep a calla lily from sitting level. Keep each flower on one clear stem, and prepare baby’s breath as small, separate sprigs.

CRAFT NOTE A level stack protects the acrylic plates and helps the pressure reach the flower evenly.

Build the paper layers



HOW TO

Set out the blotting sheets, padding, and clear plates before arranging the flowers. Keep the orange and yellow callas separate and easy to identify.

CRAFT NOTE Prepare the full layer order before the flowers go under pressure.

Place the flowers



HOW TO

Place the calla lilies and baby’s breath on the clean blotting sheet. Open each spathe gently, leave space around every flower, and keep thick stem ends away from the center.

CRAFT NOTE

Calla lilies are naturally dimensional. Flatten the spathe gently and remove bulky material before closing the press.

Cover the flowers



HOW TO

Lower a clean sheet of blotting paper over the arrangement. Keep the paper smooth as it comes down so the flowers do not shift or fold into a tight bundle.

CRAFT NOTE The cover sheet should protect the flowers without dragging across their surfaces.

Store the assembled press



HOW TO

After the four black knobs are tightened evenly on the four brass bolts, keep the 12 by 12 inch press flat in a dry indoor place with gentle, indirect light.

CRAFT NOTE Do not open the stack repeatedly while the flowers are still flexible.

Reveal the pressed flowers



HOW TO

Loosen the knobs and lift the top plate carefully. Peel the paper back slowly and support delicate pressed petals from underneath. Look for the fine veins and color shifts that make each flower unique.

CRAFT NOTE If a petal resists the paper, pause and let it dry longer. Patience protects the finished flower.